Future Vision Institute

# Future Vision English Course

# INTERMEDIATE 1

## B1.1 • CEFR

## Student Book

Longer stories, science topics, and English for real life

Stories • Topics • Science • Conversations



# Contents

## Unit 1 — Up to Now

1 Six Months at the Shop STORY 3
2 University Life TOPIC 6
3 I'd Like to Return This CONVERSATION 7

## Unit 2 — Then and Now

4 When Grandfather Was Young STORY 8
5 Life Before Phones TOPIC 11
6 Opening a Bank Account CONVERSATION 12

## Unit 3 — What Had Happened?

7 The Lost Phone STORY 14
8 Our Internet Isn't Working CONVERSATION 17

## Unit 4 — People and Things

9 The Mystery Gift STORY 18
10 Solar Power SCIENCE 21
11 What Do You Think? CONVERSATION 23

## Unit 5 — How It's Done

12 The Great Mango Mystery STORY 24
13 The Water Cycle SCIENCE 27

STORY · LESSON 1

# Six Months at the Shop

Omar has worked at the phone shop for six months. Read the story, then read it from Mr. Kamal's point of view.

Say how long something has continued | Give recent news | Use already and yet

## 1 The story

Omar **has worked** at Mr. Kamal's phone repair shop **for** six months now. He started in March, so he **has been** there **since** the spring. In that time, he **has fixed** more than four hundred phones. He **has learned** a lot about screens, batteries, and cameras, and customers **have started** to ask for him by name.

He **has** also **saved** some money. Every month, he puts a little in a box. He **has already saved** enough for a new laptop, but he **hasn't decided** what to buy **yet**. "A laptop? A motorbike? Or a trip to Port Sudan to see my family?" he asks Adam. Adam laughs. "You **have asked** me that question ten times this week!"

One evening, Mr. Kamal calls Omar into his small office. Omar is nervous. "**Have** I **done** something wrong?" "No, Omar. You **have done** everything right. I**'ve just opened** a second shop near the university, and I need someone to run it. **Have** you ever **thought** about being a manager?"

Omar can't speak for a moment. "Me? A manager? But I'm only a student!" "You **have been** my best worker **since** your first day," Mr. Kamal says. "And you can still study in the mornings." That night, Omar calls his mother in Port Sudan. "Mom, I**'ve just become** a manager!" His mother is quiet for a second. Then she laughs. "And **have** you **learned** to cook fish **yet**?"

## 2 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **How long has Omar worked at the shop?**
For six months.

2 **When did he start?**
In March.

3 **How many phones has he fixed?**
More than four hundred.

4 **Has he saved any money?**
Yes, he has.

Six Months at the Shop (continued)

## 2 Questions and answers (continued)

**5** **Has he decided what to buy yet?**
No, he hasn't.

**6** **What are his three ideas?**
A laptop, a motorbike, or a trip to Port Sudan.

**7** **Why is Omar nervous?**
Mr. Kamal calls him into his office.

**8** **Has Omar done something wrong?**
No, he hasn't. He has done everything right.

**9** **What has Mr. Kamal just opened?**
A second shop near the university.

**10** **What job does Mr. Kamal offer Omar?**
Manager of the new shop.

**11** **Can Omar still study?**
Yes, in the mornings.

**12** **What does his mother ask?**
If he has learned to cook fish yet!

## 3 Point of view

Now Mr. Kamal tells the story. He says when things happened.

**MK**

Omar **has worked** in my shop **for** six months. He **started** in March, and **since** then he **has fixed** more than four hundred phones. Customers **have started** to ask for him by name.

I know he **has saved** some money, because he talks about it all the time! But he **hasn't decided** what to buy **yet**.

Last month, I **opened** a second shop near the university, and I needed a manager. So yesterday, I **called** Omar into my office. He was nervous. "**Have** I **done** something wrong?" he asked.

"No," I said. "You **have been** my best worker **since** your first day. Will you run my new shop?" He couldn't speak for a moment. I think I**'ve just made** a very good decision.

Six Months at the Shop (continued)

## 4 What did you learn?

### You learned for · since · just · already · yet.

We use them with the present perfect, for things that started in the past and continue now, and for recent news.

| WORD | WE USE IT FOR | EXAMPLE |
|---|---|---|
| for | a length of time | He has worked there for six months. |
| since | the start of a time | He has been there since March. |
| just | a very short time ago | I have just opened a second shop. |
| already | sooner than we thought | He has already saved enough. |
| yet | until now (no and questions) | He hasn't decided yet. Have you learned yet? |

**for + a length, since + a start**
for six months · since March

**just · already before the participle**
I have just opened. He has already saved.

**yet at the end**
He hasn't decided yet.

QUESTIONS **How long have you studied English?** For two years. / Since 2024.

## 5 New words

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **saved** | kept money for later | **laptop** | a small computer you can carry |
| **motorbike** | a bike with an engine | **run** | here: manage a shop or a business |
| **manager** | the person who controls a shop or a team | **decision** | what you choose after thinking |

TOPIC · LESSON 2

# University Life

Sara has started engineering. What has she learned so far?

Talk about university | Compare school and university | Say what you have done so far

## 1 Read

Three months ago, Sara started her first year at the **Faculty of Engineering**. University life is very different from school, and she has learned a lot already.

First, the timetable. At school, every day was the same. At university, Sara has **lectures** in the morning on some days and **labs** in the afternoon on others. She has already learned to plan her own week.

Second, the work. Her **professors** give a lot of reading, and they don't check homework every day. Students have to study alone. Sara has joined a **study group** with four classmates, and they meet in the library twice a week.

Third, people. Sara has made new friends from all over Sudan, from Kassala, El Obeid, and Port Sudan. Some of them have never lived in a big city before.

Has it been easy? Not always. She hasn't finished her first project yet, and her first exams are next month. But she is happy. "I've wanted to be an engineer since I was a child," she says. "Now I'm on my way."

## 2 School and university

**School**
the same timetable every day · teachers check homework

**University**
lectures and labs · students study alone

## 3 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **When did Sara start university?**
Three months ago.

2 **What does she study?**
Engineering.

3 **Has she learned to plan her own week?**
Yes, she already has.

4 **How often does her study group meet?**
Twice a week, in the library.

University Life (continued)

## 3 Questions and answers (continued)

**5 Where are her new friends from?**
From all over Sudan: Kassala, El Obeid, and Port Sudan.

**6 Has she finished her first project yet?**
No, she hasn't.

## 4 New words

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **faculty** | a part of a university, like engineering or medicine | **timetable** | a list of the times of your classes |
| **lectures** | classes where a professor talks to many students | **labs** | rooms for scientific work |
| **professors** | university teachers | **project** | a big piece of work |

CONVERSATION · LESSON 3

# I'd Like to Return This

Taking back something that doesn't work

- Explain a problem with something you bought
- Ask for a refund
- Answer the shop's questions

## 1 Read the conversation

*Adam bought some headphones last week, and they have stopped working. He goes back to the shop.*

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| AS | ASSISTANT | Good morning. How can I help you? |
| A | ADAM | Hi. I bought these headphones here last week, but they've stopped working. |
| AS | ASSISTANT | I'm sorry to hear that. What's the problem? |
| A | ADAM | The left side doesn't work. I've only used them for three days. |
| AS | ASSISTANT | Do you have the receipt? |
| A | ADAM | Yes, here it is. |
| AS | ASSISTANT | Thank you. Would you like a new pair, or your money back? |
| A | ADAM | I'd like a refund, please. I've already found a better pair online. |
| AS | ASSISTANT | No problem. Here's your money, and here's a new receipt. |
| A | ADAM | Great. Thanks for your help. |

I'd Like to Return This (continued)

## 2 Useful phrases

**EXPLAIN THE PROBLEM**
They've stopped working.

**SAY HOW LONG**
I've only used them for three days.

**SHOW THE RECEIPT**
Do you have the receipt?
— Yes, here it is.

**CHOOSE**
Would you like a new pair, or your money back?

**ASK FOR A REFUND**
I'd like a refund, please.

**THANK**
Thanks for your help.

## 3 New words

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **return** | take something back to the shop | **headphones** | something you wear on your ears to listen |
| **receipt** | the paper you get when you pay | **pair** | two things that are used together |
| **refund** | money that is given back to you | **online** | on the internet |

STORY · LESSON 4

# When Grandfather Was Young

Adam shows his grandfather a video, and his grandfather tells him how life used to be. Read the story, then read it from Grandfather's point of view.

Talk about past habits | Compare the past and now | Ask about someone's past

## 1 The story

Last weekend, Adam visited his grandfather in the village. In the evening, they sat under the big tree, and Adam showed him a video on his phone. His grandfather smiled. "When I was your age, we **didn't use to** have phones. We **didn't** even **use to** have electricity!"

When Grandfather Was Young (continued)

## 1 The story (continued)

"So how did you study at night?" Adam asked. "We **used to** read by an oil lamp. My brothers and I **used to** sit around it after dinner and do our homework. And every morning, I **used to** walk five kilometers to school, without shoes."

"Five kilometers? Every day?" "Every day. And on the way, we **used to** stop at the river and swim. The teacher **used to** be very angry when we arrived wet!" Adam laughed. "**Did** you **use to** get in trouble?" "Oh, yes. All the time."

"What did you **use to** do for fun?" Adam asked. "We **used to** play football with a ball made of old cloth, and we **used to** listen to stories from the old men of the village. That was our TV." Adam put his phone in his pocket. "Grandfather, tell me one of those stories." His grandfather smiled and began.

## 2 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **Where did Adam go last weekend?**
To his grandfather's village.

2 **What did Adam show his grandfather?**
A video on his phone.

3 **Did his grandfather use to have a phone?**
No, he didn't.

4 **Did they use to have electricity?**
No, they didn't.

5 **How did they study at night?**
They used to read by an oil lamp.

6 **How far did he use to walk to school?**
Five kilometers.

7 **Did he use to wear shoes to school?**
No, he didn't.

8 **Where did they use to stop on the way?**
At the river, to swim.

9 **Why was the teacher angry?**
Because they arrived wet.

10 **What did they use to play?**
Football, with a ball made of old cloth.

11 **What was their TV?**
Stories from the old men of the village.

12 **What did Adam do with his phone at the end?**
He put it in his pocket.

When Grandfather Was Young (continued)

## 3 Point of view

Now Adam's grandfather tells it, and compares then and now.

G

When I was a boy, we **didn't use to** have phones or electricity. At night, my brothers and I **used to** sit around an oil lamp and do our homework.

Every morning, I **used to** walk five kilometers to school, without shoes. On the way, we **used to** stop at the river and swim, and the teacher **used to** be very angry when we arrived wet!

For fun, we **used to** play football with a ball of old cloth, and we **used to** listen to the old men's stories. That was our TV.

Now my grandson **has** a phone with a thousand videos. But last weekend, he put it in his pocket and asked me for a story. That made me very happy.

## 4 What did you learn?

### You learned used to.

We use it for things that happened again and again in the past, or were true in the past, but are not true now.

| IN THE PAST (NOT NOW) | NOW |
|---|---|
| We **used to** read by an oil lamp. | We **read** by electric light. |
| He **used to** walk to school. | Many children **take** the bus. |
| We **didn't use to** have phones. | Almost everybody **has** a phone. |

**used to + verb, the same for everyone**
I used to, she used to, they used to.

**No and questions: didn't use to · Did … use to?**
No -d after didn't and Did.

**Only for the past**
For now, use the present simple: I walk to school.

QUESTIONS **What did you use to do when you were a child?**

I used to play football every day.

When Grandfather Was Young (continued)

## 5 New words

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **electricity** | the power that makes lights and machines work | **lamp** | a light; an oil lamp burns oil |
| **kilometers** | a kilometer is a thousand meters | **trouble** | problems because you did something wrong |
| **cloth** | material for clothes | **pocket** | a small bag in your clothes |

TOPIC · LESSON 5

# Life Before Phones

How people used to send news, talk, and listen, before mobile phones.

Talk about life in the past · Compare then and now · Give your opinion about change

## 1 Read

Today, we can send a message to anyone in the world in one second. But how did people **communicate** before mobile phones?

Many people used to write **letters**. A letter from Khartoum to a village in the north used to take two or three weeks. Families used to wait for the post and read their letters again and again.

Some homes had a **landline**, a phone with a wire that stayed in one place. Calls to other cities used to be very expensive, so people used to talk quickly! In villages without phones, people used to go to the post office to make a call.

For news, people used to listen to the **radio**. In the evening, the whole family used to sit together and listen to the news, football matches, and songs.

Life was slower, but some people miss it. "We didn't use to look at screens all day," says Adam's grandfather. "We used to look at each other."

## 2 Then and now

**letters**
then: two or three weeks · now: one second

**landline**
then: in one place · now: in your pocket

**radio**
then: news for the whole family · now: apps

Life Before Phones (continued)

## 3 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

**1 How long did a letter to a village use to take?**
Two or three weeks.

**2 What is a landline?**
A phone with a wire that stays in one place.

**3 Why did people use to talk quickly on the phone?**
Calls to other cities were very expensive.

**4 Where did people in villages use to make calls?**
At the post office.

**5 What did families use to listen to in the evening?**
The radio: the news, football matches, and songs.

**6 What does Adam's grandfather miss?**
People used to look at each other, not at screens.

## 4 New words

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **communicate** | share information with other people | **mobile** | that you can carry with you |
| **post** | the letters that are brought to your home | **wire** | a long thin metal line for electricity |
| **whole** | all of it | **miss** | feel sad because something is not there now |

CONVERSATION · LESSON 6

# Opening a Bank Account

At the bank, opening an account for a salary

Open a bank account | Talk about the past and now | Ask how a service works

## 1 Read the conversation

*Omar is a manager now. He goes to the bank to open an account for his salary.*

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| CL | CLERK | Good morning. How can I help you? |
| O | OMAR | I'd like to open a bank account, please. |
| CL | CLERK | Of course. Have you ever had an account with us? |
| O | OMAR | No. I used to keep my money at home, in a box under my bed! |

Opening a Bank Account (continued)

## 1 Read the conversation (continued)

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| CL | CLERK | It's safer in the bank. Can I see your ID, please? |
| O | OMAR | Here you are. I've just started a new job as a manager. |
| CL | CLERK | Congratulations! Your salary can come directly into your account. |
| O | OMAR | Great. Can I use my phone to check my money? |
| CL | CLERK | Yes, you can use our app. You'll get your bank card in a week. |
| O | OMAR | Perfect. No more boxes under the bed! |

## 2 Useful phrases

**SAY WHAT YOU WANT**
I'd like to open a bank account.

**TALK ABOUT THE PAST**
I used to keep my money at home.

**SHOW YOUR ID**
Can I see your ID, please?
— Here you are.

**TALK ABOUT YOUR JOB**
I've just started a new job.

**ASK ABOUT THE APP**
Can I use my phone to check my money?
— Yes, you can.

**GET YOUR CARD**
You'll get your bank card in a week.

## 3 New words

**account** — a place in a bank where your money is kept

**safer** — more safe

**salary** — the money you get every month for your work

**directly** — straight, with nothing in between

STORY · LESSON 7

# The Lost Phone

Sara left her phone in a rickshaw. Read the story, then read it from the driver's point of view.

Tell a story in the past | Say which thing happened first | Use the past perfect

## 1 The story

Last Thursday, Sara took a rickshaw from the university to the institute. When she arrived, she paid the driver and ran into class. Mr. Ali **had already started** the lesson. Sara sat down and opened her bag. Her phone wasn't there.

She looked everywhere. She **had put** it in her bag that morning, she was sure. Then she remembered. She **had taken** it out in the rickshaw to check the time, and she **had left** it on the seat! Her face went white. All her photos, her notes, and her university timetable were on that phone.

"Don't worry," Omar said. "Let's call it." He called Sara's number. Nobody answered. He called again. This time, a man answered. "Hello? I'm the rickshaw driver. I **had already driven** two kilometers when I saw the phone on the seat. I came back, but you **had already gone** inside!"

Ten minutes later, the driver was at the institute door with the phone. Sara thanked him again and again, and she tried to give him some money, but he said no. "My daughter is a student, too," he said. "I know how important a phone is." After he **had left**, Mr. Ali smiled. "Now, Sara. **Had** you **done** your homework before you lost your phone?"

## 2 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **How did Sara go to the institute last Thursday?**
By rickshaw.

2 **Had the lesson started when she arrived?**
Yes, it had. Mr. Ali had already started.

3 **What wasn't in her bag?**
Her phone.

4 **Where had she put her phone that morning?**
In her bag.

The Lost Phone (continued)

## 2 Questions and answers (continued)

**5 Why had she taken it out in the rickshaw?**
To check the time.

**6 Where had she left it?**
On the seat of the rickshaw.

**7 Who called Sara's number?**
Omar.

**8 Who answered the second time?**
The rickshaw driver.

**9 How far had the driver gone when he saw the phone?**
Two kilometers.

**10 Did the driver take money from Sara?**
No, he didn't.

**11 Why did he understand?**
His daughter is a student, too.

**12 What did Mr. Ali ask Sara?**
If she had done her homework before she lost her phone!

## 3 Point of view

Now the rickshaw driver tells it.

**D**

Last Thursday, I drove a young woman from the university to the institute. She paid and ran inside, because her class **had already started**.

I **had already driven** two kilometers when I saw a phone on the back seat. She **had left** it there! I turned around and went back to the institute, but she **had already gone** inside.

Then the phone rang. A young man was calling. "This is Sara's phone," he said. "She is in class." So I took it to the door.

She thanked me again and again, and she tried to give me money. But I said no. My daughter is a student, too, and I know how important a phone is.

The Lost Phone (continued)

## 4 What did you learn?

### You learned the past perfect.

We use it for something that happened before another thing in the past. It shows which came first.

| FIRST: PAST PERFECT | THEN: PAST SIMPLE |
|---|---|
| Mr. Ali had already started the lesson | when Sara arrived. |
| She had left her phone on the seat, | so she didn't have it in class. |
| The driver had driven two kilometers | when he saw the phone. |
| After he had left, | Mr. Ali smiled. |

**had + past participle, the same for everyone**
I had gone, she had gone, they had gone.

**already means before the other thing**
She had already gone inside.

**Questions: Had you…?**
Had you done your homework? Yes, I had.

QUESTIONS **Had the lesson started when you arrived?** Yes, it had. / No, it hadn't.

## 5 New words

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **arrived** | came to a place | **remembered** | thought of something again |
| **notes** | short writing that helps you remember | **important** | needed very much; that matters a lot |
| **thanked** | said thank you | **turned around** | went back the way you came |

CONVERSATION · LESSON 8

# Our Internet Isn't Working

Calling customer service about a problem

Explain a problem on the phone · Say what you had already tried · Ask how long it will take

## 1 Read the conversation

*The internet at Adam's home has stopped working. He calls the internet company.*

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| AG | AGENT | Good afternoon, Nile Net. How can I help you? |
| A | ADAM | Hi. Our internet isn't working. It had worked perfectly until last night. |
| AG | AGENT | I'm sorry about that. Have you restarted the router? |
| A | ADAM | Yes. I had already restarted it twice before I called you. |
| AG | AGENT | OK. What do the lights on the router show? |
| A | ADAM | The green light is on, but the red light is flashing. |
| AG | AGENT | Thank you. I can see a problem in your area. Our engineers are fixing it now. |
| A | ADAM | How long will it take? I have an online class at eight. |
| AG | AGENT | It should work again in about two hours. We're sorry for the trouble. |
| A | ADAM | OK. Thanks for your help. |

## 2 Useful phrases

**EXPLAIN THE PROBLEM**
Our internet isn't working.

**SAY WHAT HAPPENED BEFORE**
It had worked perfectly until last night.

**SAY WHAT YOU TRIED**
I had already restarted it twice.

**DESCRIBE IT**
The red light is flashing.

**ASK HOW LONG**
How long will it take?
— About two hours.

**ANSWER AN APOLOGY**
OK. Thanks for your help.

## 3 New words

**perfectly** — very well

**router** — the small machine that brings the internet into your home

**area** — a part of a city

**restarted** — turned off and on again

**flashing** — going on and off quickly

STORY · LESSON 9

# The Mystery Gift

A gift with no name appears on Mr. Ali's desk. Read the story, then read it from the giver's point of view.

Describe people and things | Join two ideas with who and which | Find clues

## 1 The story

On Monday morning, Mr. Ali found a small box on his desk. It was in blue paper, and there was a card on top. The card said, "For the teacher **who** never gets angry. From someone **who** loves English." There was no name.

Mr. Ali opened the box. Inside, there was a beautiful pen **that** had his name on it. "Who left this?" he asked. Nobody answered. "OK," said Sara. "Let's be detectives. The person **who** left it is probably in this class."

The students looked for clues. Omar found the first one, a piece of blue paper **which** was on the floor near the window. "Who sits by the window?" he asked. Three students put up their hands. Then Adam looked at the card. The writing was green. "Who uses a green pen?"

Only one of the students **who** sat by the window used a green pen. It was Huda, a quiet girl **who** always helps the others. "Huda, is it you?" Huda went red. "Yes. Mr. Ali is the teacher **who** helped me most when my English was weak." Mr. Ali smiled. "This is the place **where** I have been happiest," he said. "And this is the class **that** I will never forget."

## 2 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **What did Mr. Ali find on his desk?**
A small box in blue paper.

2 **What did the card say?**
"For the teacher who never gets angry. From someone who loves English."

3 **Was there a name on the card?**
No, there wasn't.

4 **What was inside the box?**
A beautiful pen that had his name on it.

5 **Whose idea was it to be detectives?**
Sara's.

The Mystery Gift (continued)

## 2 Questions and answers (continued)

**6 What was the first clue?**
A piece of blue paper which was on the floor near the window.

**7 Who found it?**
Omar.

**8 How many students sit by the window?**
Three.

**9 What was the second clue?**
The writing on the card was green.

**10 Who left the gift?**
Huda.

**11 Why did she leave it?**
Mr. Ali is the teacher who helped her most.

**12 What did Mr. Ali say about the class?**
It is the class that he will never forget.

## 3 Point of view Now Huda tells it.

H

Mr. Ali is the teacher **who** helped me most when my English was weak. So last weekend, I bought a pen **that** had his name on it, and I wrapped it in blue paper.

On Monday, I came early and put the box on his desk. On the card, I wrote, "For the teacher **who** never gets angry." I used my green pen, **which** was a big mistake!

The students became detectives. Omar found a piece of the paper **which** had fallen near my seat by the window. Then Adam saw the green writing. Everybody looked at the girl **who** sits by the window and uses a green pen.

I went red. But Mr. Ali smiled. "This is the class **that** I will never forget," he said.

The Mystery Gift (continued)

## 4 What did you learn?

### You learned who, which, that and where.

We use them to join two ideas, and to say which person, thing, or place we mean.

| WORD | FOR | EXAMPLE |
|---|---|---|
| who | people | the teacher who never gets angry |
| which | things | a piece of paper which was on the floor |
| that | people or things | a pen that had his name on it |
| where | places | the place where I have been happiest |

**One sentence, not two**
He is a teacher. He helps everyone. → He is a teacher who helps everyone.

**that can take the place of who or which**
the class that I will never forget

**No extra he · she · it**
the pen that had his name. Not: the pen that it had his name.

QUESTIONS **Who is the student who sits by the window?** It's Huda.

## 5 New words

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **detectives** | people who find out who did something | **clues** | things that help you find an answer |
| **probably** | almost sure | **weak** | not strong |
| **forget** | not remember | **wrapped** | covered in paper |

SCIENCE · LESSON 10

# Solar Power

How solar panels turn sunlight into electricity, and why they are good for Sudan.

- Explain how a machine works
- Describe things with which and who
- Give good and bad points

## 1 Read

Sudan is one of the sunniest countries in the world. In many places, the sun shines for more than ten hours a day. That is a lot of free **energy**, and more and more people are using it with **solar panels**.

A solar panel is a flat board which is covered with special **cells**. These cells are made of a material called silicon, which comes from sand. When sunlight hits the cells, it moves tiny parts inside them, and this movement makes **electricity**.

The electricity can be used at once, or it can be kept in a **battery** for the night. People who live far from the cities, where there are no power lines, can now have lights, fans, and even TVs.

Solar power has other good points. It is clean, because it doesn't make smoke. It is quiet, unlike the generators that many families use during power cuts. And after you have bought the panels, the sunlight is free.

There are some problems, too. Solar panels are still expensive for many families, and they need cleaning when dust covers them. But scientists who study energy say that one day, the sun will be Sudan's most important source of power.

## 2 How it works

1. **sunlight** — hits the panel
2. **cells** — make electricity
3. **battery** — keeps it for the night
4. **home** — lights and fans work

**DID YOU KNOW?** The sunlight that falls on the Earth in one hour has about as much energy as all the people in the world use in a whole year.

Solar Power (continued)

## 3 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

**1 How long does the sun shine in many places in Sudan?**
More than ten hours a day.

**2 What is a solar panel?**
A flat board which is covered with special cells.

**3 What are the cells made of?**
Silicon, which comes from sand.

**4 What happens when sunlight hits the cells?**
It moves tiny parts inside them, and this makes electricity.

**5 Where is the electricity kept for the night?**
In a battery.

**6 Who can now have lights and fans?**
People who live far from the cities, where there are no power lines.

**7 Why is solar power clean?**
Because it doesn't make smoke.

**8 What are two problems with solar panels?**
They are still expensive, and they need cleaning when dust covers them.

## 4 New words

| | |
|---|---|
| **energy** | power that makes things work |
| **tiny** | very small |
| **dust** | very small dry pieces of dirt |
| **material** | what something is made of |
| **generators** | machines that make electricity, usually with fuel |
| **source** | the place where something comes from |

CONVERSATION · LESSON 11

# What Do You Think?

Giving opinions, agreeing, and disagreeing politely

Give your opinion | Agree and disagree politely | Change your mind

## 1 Read the conversation

*In class, Mr. Ali asks the students a question. Should the institute buy solar panels?*

| | |
|---|---|
| MR. ALI | The institute is thinking about solar panels. What do you think? |
| SARA | In my opinion, it's a great idea. We're the class that always loses power in the evening! |
| OMAR | I agree. And the generator which we use now is very noisy. |
| ADAM | I see your point, but solar panels are expensive. Who will pay for them? |
| SARA | That's true, but the institute will save money on fuel in the long run. |
| OMAR | Exactly. And people who see the panels will think the institute is modern. |
| ADAM | OK, you've changed my mind. But who's going to clean them? |
| SARA | The students who come late! |
| MR. ALI | Good idea, Sara. Adam, I'm looking at you. |
| ADAM | Hey! That was only once! |

## 2 Useful phrases

**ASK FOR AN OPINION**
What do you think?

**GIVE YOUR OPINION**
In my opinion, it's a great idea.

**AGREE**
I agree. · Exactly.

**DISAGREE POLITELY**
I see your point, but…

**ACCEPT A POINT**
That's true, but…

**CHANGE YOUR MIND**
OK, you've changed my mind.

## 3 New words

| | |
|---|---|
| **opinion** | what you think about something |
| **fuel** | what we burn to make power, like gas or oil |
| **modern** | new; of today |
| **noisy** | making a lot of noise |
| **in the long run** | after a long time |
| **changed my mind** | made me think differently |

STORY · LESSON 12

# The Great Mango Mystery

Every morning, mangoes disappear from the institute's tree. Read the story, then read Mr. Ali's version, which says who did each thing.

Say what happens or happened | Use the passive | Say who did something with by

## 1 The story

In the garden of Future Vision Institute, there is an old mango tree. Every year, hundreds of mangoes **are grown** on it, and they **are shared** by everyone, students, teachers, and the cleaners.

But this year, something strange happened. Every morning, mangoes **were taken** from the tree. On Sunday, ten mangoes **were taken**. On Monday, fifteen. By Wednesday, the lowest branches were empty. "Someone is taking our mangoes!" said Mr. Ali. Adam looked at Omar, and Omar looked at Adam. "Don't look at me!" they both said.

A meeting **was held** in the office. A camera **was placed** near the tree, and the gate **was locked** every evening. But the next morning, ten more mangoes **were taken**, and the gate was still locked!

On Thursday, the video **was checked**. Everybody watched the screen. At two in the morning, small dark shapes flew into the tree. They were fruit bats! "So the mangoes **weren't stolen** by people," Omar laughed. "They **were eaten** by bats!" Now a net **is put** over the tree every night, and the mangoes **are shared** by everyone again, but not by the bats.

## 2 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **What is in the garden of the institute?**
An old mango tree.

2 **Who are the mangoes shared by?**
Everyone: students, teachers, and the cleaners.

3 **What happened every morning this year?**
Mangoes were taken from the tree.

4 **How many mangoes were taken on Monday?**
Fifteen.

The Great Mango Mystery (continued)

## 2 Questions and answers (continued)

5 **Where was a meeting held?**
In the office.

6 **Where was a camera placed?**
Near the tree.

7 **Was the gate locked?**
Yes, it was locked every evening.

8 **Were more mangoes taken after that?**
Yes, ten more.

9 **When was the video checked?**
On Thursday.

10 **What was seen in the video?**
Fruit bats flying into the tree.

11 **Were the mangoes stolen by people?**
No, they weren't. They were eaten by bats.

12 **What is put over the tree now?**
A net, every night.

## 3 Point of view

Now Mr. Ali tells it, and says who did each thing.

**MA**

Every year, our old mango tree **grows** hundreds of mangoes, and everyone **shares** them.

But this year, someone **took** mangoes every morning. By Wednesday, the lowest branches were empty.

We **held** a meeting in the office. Omar **placed** a camera near the tree, and the guard **locked** the gate every evening. But the next morning, more mangoes were gone!

On Thursday, we **checked** the video. Fruit bats **ate** our mangoes! Now the guard **puts** a net over the tree every night, and everyone **shares** the mangoes again.

The Great Mango Mystery (continued)

## 4 What did you learn?

### You learned the passive.

We use it when the action is more important than the person who does it, or when we don't know who does it.

| ACTIVE: WHO DOES IT | PASSIVE: WHAT HAPPENS |
|---|---|
| Everyone **shares** the mangoes. | The mangoes **are shared** by everyone. |
| Someone **took** the mangoes. | The mangoes **were taken**. |
| Omar **placed** a camera near the tree. | A camera **was placed** near the tree. |
| Bats **ate** the mangoes. | The mangoes **were eaten** by bats. |

**be + past participle**
is shared, are shared, was taken, were eaten

**by says who did it**
They were eaten by bats.

**Science uses it a lot**
Water is heated by the sun. Clouds are formed.

QUESTIONS **Were the mangoes stolen?** No, they weren't. They were eaten by bats!

## 5 New words

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **branches** | the parts of a tree that grow out like arms | **held** | the past of hold: held a meeting |
| **placed** | put | **locked** | closed with a key |
| **bats** | small animals that fly at night; fruit bats eat fruit | **net** | material with many small holes |

SCIENCE · LESSON 13

# The Water Cycle

Where does rain come from? Follow the journey of water from the sea to the sky and back.

Explain a process in steps | Use the passive to describe science | Connect science to life in Sudan

## 1 Read

Have you ever wondered where rain comes from? The answer is the **water cycle**, the journey that water makes again and again between the sea, the sky, and the land.

First comes **evaporation**. Every day, water in seas, rivers, and lakes is heated by the sun. When it gets warm, it turns into a gas called water vapor, which rises into the air.

Next comes **condensation**. High in the sky, the air is much colder. The water vapor is cooled, and it changes back into very small drops of water. Millions of these drops are joined together, and clouds are formed.

Then comes **precipitation**. When the drops become too big and heavy, they fall to the ground as rain. In very cold places, the water falls as snow.

Last comes **collection**. The rainwater is collected in rivers, lakes, and under the ground. Some of it is used by plants, animals, and people. The rest flows back to the sea, and the cycle starts again.

In Sudan, most rain falls between July and September. A lot of this water is carried by the Blue Nile from the mountains of Ethiopia, and it is used by farmers all along the river.

## 2 The four steps

**1 evaporation**
water is heated and rises

**2 condensation**
vapor is cooled; clouds are formed

**3 precipitation**
water falls as rain

**4 collection**
water is collected in rivers and seas

The Water Cycle (continued)

**DID YOU KNOW?** The water in your glass may be millions of years old. It has been through the water cycle many, many times!

## 3 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **What is the water cycle?**
The journey that water makes again and again between the sea, the sky, and the land.

2 **What happens when water is heated by the sun?**
It turns into water vapor and rises into the air.

3 **Why does the vapor change back into drops?**
Because the air high in the sky is colder.

4 **How are clouds formed?**
Millions of small drops are joined together.

5 **When does water fall as rain?**
When the drops become too big and heavy.

6 **Where is rainwater collected?**
In rivers, lakes, and under the ground.

7 **When does most rain fall in Sudan?**
Between July and September.

8 **Who uses the water of the Blue Nile?**
Farmers all along the river.

## 4 New words

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **cycle** | something that happens again and again in the same order | **journey** | a trip from one place to another |
| **vapor** | water as a gas in the air | **rises** | goes up |
| **formed** | made | **flows** | moves like water in a river |